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Ubena of the Rivers

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The tribal heirlooms, stuck upright in the ground, are ranged along the foot of the wall behind the *linyáútwá*. Standing apart in the left-hand corner are two small spearheads (Fig. I, 1 and 2), one which was sent by Chabruma with the blade bent over as a sign of a beaten enemy suing for peace (see pp. 170–1), and the other, unbent, which came from the Hehe Chief Mkwawa as a mark of respect for an honoured foe. At the right-hand side stand three curious iron objects (Fig. I, 3, 4, and 5), very old in appearance. An interesting feature is the imitation of cord lashings which occurs at the head of the shaft in each case, suggesting an earlier composite form. Towegale and Barakali particularly pointed out these simulated lashings as an interesting decoration. What the objects are they have no idea, nor do they know whence they came beyond the fact that Manga brought them with him as heirlooms handed down from his remote ancestors. Nothing similar is found among the Wabena or their neighbours, save only that the Wahehe are said also to have a *mahóngoli* in which, since Manga took the originals, they have placed copies of these ancient objects. Manga's retention of the heirlooms throws an interesting side-light on the unwillingness of the Wakinimanga to acknowledge the claims of the Wayinga *aselder* brothers. Next these strange iron implements stands a ceremonial axe with a long wavy tang (Fig. I, 6), and in the corner of the room is the worn little royal Stool which has come down from Mtengera.

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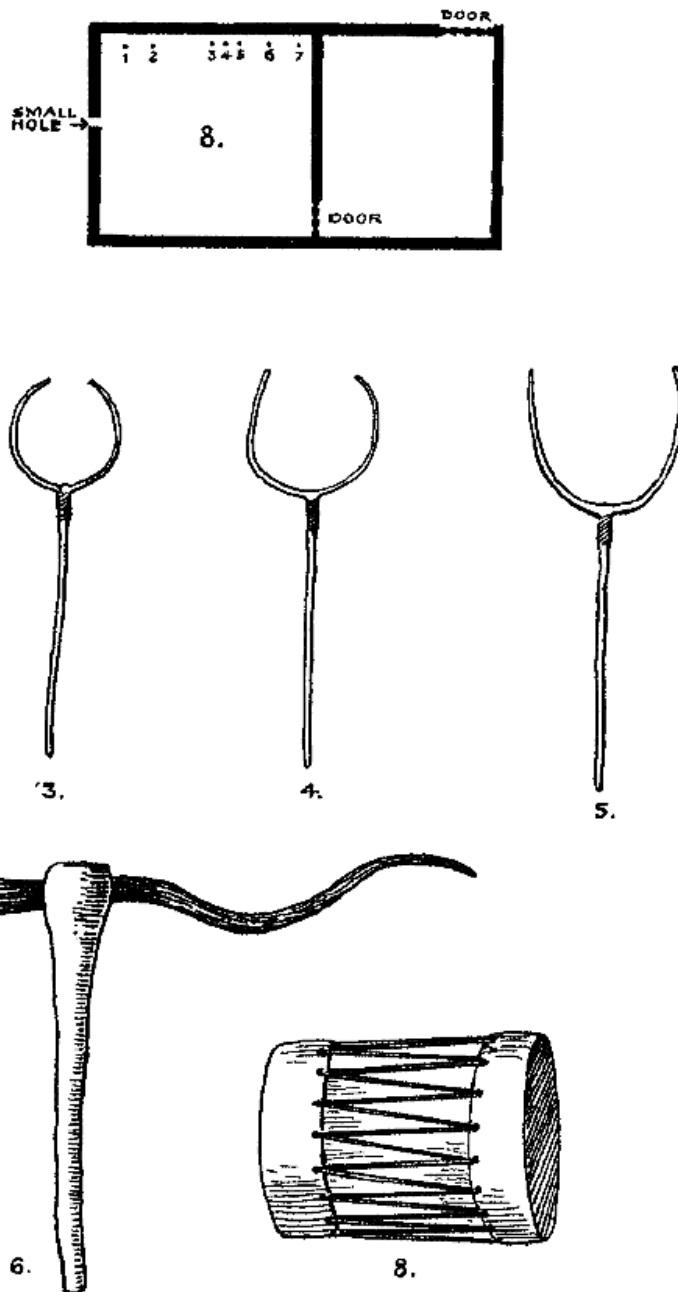
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A somewhat amusing incident occurred later the same day in connection with the pronged heirlooms. The other writer, who had not yet heard all about the contents of the *mahóngoli*, was busy with callipers measuring heads, when she noticed Barakali observing her intently from a little distance, staring ■ 111

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Fig. I.



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112 open-mouthed at the callipers, with his eyes starting out of his head. Still staring, he came closer and gazed long and earnestly at them over her shoulder, breathing beery breaths down her neck, for festivities were in progress celebrating the successful *tambiko* outside the *mahóngoli* on the previous night in connection with the formal opening of Towegale's new court-house. Knowing nothing of the significance and associations implements of such a shape might have for Barakali, she invited him to be measured—whereat he fled without vouchsafing a single word. Presently, however, fortified by a little more beer, he plucked up courage and came back jauntily, laughing and joking, and sat down to be measured.

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